

Payments, Processors & IT Services

Visa-OpenAI Partnership, Mastercard Agent Pay for Machines: Cards firmly enter the agentic era



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Visa today announced a partnership with OpenAI ([link](#)) to essentially enable agentic commerce, conversational agentic workflows and developer experiences through Visa Intelligent Commerce (including Visa agent tokens) and services. Visa and OpenAI are solving for two key focus areas 1) seamless agentic commerce experiences, 2) exploring future agentic economy use cases including developer-focused autonomous agent experiences powered by Codex, and conversational automated workflows. For anyone who has doubted Visa's (and cards') positioning in agentic commerce and machine-to-machine payments - we believe this partnership is a strong proof point that cards have firmly entered the agentic era of commerce. To be clear, we believe this is a 5yr opportunity (not a 2yr one) but it is critical to the multiple.

V (and MA) are networks of trust (and often misunderstood as backend money movement which settlement layers handle). **Agents will (eventually) bring a paradigm shift in how we engage in commerce experiences, and simultaneously bring new economic models/payments** (e.g., automated agent workflows). **A massive trust infrastructure will be required to facilitate these commerce experiences** - and cards are extremely well positioned.

OpenAI's comment in the release was quite noteworthy: "Commerce is going to happen in many more places and in many more ways than it does today, and agents will play an increasingly important role in helping people complete tasks that involve money—from purchases and payments to more complex transactions." "By integrating with Visa Intelligent Commerce, we're building the infrastructure for secure, transparent, and user-controlled agentic transactions, helping people do more with AI agents while maintaining confidence that payments are being handled securely."

The announcements today **not only provide a big stamp of approval for agentic card tokens but also a proof point that value-added services' (VAS) growth opportunity will be enhanced with agentic** (e.g., around authentication tokenization, risk, fraud). **For example, Visa announced new services today — Agent Score** (allows merchants to evaluate their websites for agentic commerce readiness), **Agentic Directory** (whether the merchant or agents are verified), and Large Transaction Model (for fraud detection).

Concurrently, with this announcement, Visa also announced enhancements to its tokens — bringing more data (e.g., on transaction type, where token is being used and who is making the payment), assurance (using token history to generate a signal of trust behind each transaction) and context — to enable agent-initiated transactions. Note that all these create monetization opportunities in the future.

It is likely that OpenAI announces a partnership around Mastercard AgentPay for agentic commerce, but unclear if it will include the future enterprise machine payment use-case. **Separately, we note that Mastercard also introduced [Agent Pay for Machines \(AP4M\)](#) today**, a new credentialed multi-rail service to enable permissioned machine payments. Partners include Adyen, Ant, Checkout, Coinbase, Lovable, Stripe, etc.

Taking a step back, Agentic Commerce is often discussed as a potential risk for Visa/Mastercard. It's very much the opposite (more digitization, transactions, & VAS).

In the agentic world (where trust will be scarce), cards (with an array of services, 7B+ credentials, 100m+ merchants) will quite likely be the payment method of choice. Cards can also easily adjust their commercial models to accommodate autonomous agent transactions (including very small ticket transactions for compute, tokens, images). V/MA have done this historically to make transit and vending machine small-ticket transactions addressable. There is then the optionality with B2B where agentic commerce has the strongest product market fit.

We wonder if the news including the ones from today help the narrative around the networks transition from an 'AI trade funding source trade' to 'AI winners'. We also note that several key overhangs are now somewhat behind us including CCCA (likelihood quite low vs. beginning of the year), the MDL settlement and Illinois card fee lawsuit. Also, good to remember that networks are excellent inflation hedges (and get paid on bps on gas spend).

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We rate V, MA, TOST, Adyen, XYZ OP. We rate FISV, FIS, GPN, KLAR and PYPL MP.

PLEASE SEE LINKS TO OUR PREVIOUS RELATED NOTES:

- [Payments: Visa/Mastercard merchant settlement preliminary approval; A closure, finally?](#) (June 2026)
- [The Long View: Payments - Does Cash Digitization Runway Still Exist?](#) (June 2026)
- [Weekend Tech Byte: The 'cost' of cards — the often misleading comparisons; our perspectives in key charts](#) (June 2026)
- [Visa: Reflections on our Fireside Chat with CEO Ryan McInerney](#) (May 2026)
- [Payments: Stablecoins — What we learned from our dozens of industry conversations; Slide deck](#) (May 2026)
- [The Age of Agents: Insights from our Inaugural Agentic Commerce Day](#) (April 2026)
- [Visa, Mastercard: Payments-ocalypse, will AI doom the networks?](#) (March 2026)
- [The Age of Agents: How does it change commerce and how we pay?](#) (December 2025)

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	10 Jun 2026		Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
		Cur	Closing Price			Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
ADYEY (Adyen)	O	USD	9.14	18.63	(77.0)%	USD	0.39	0.50	0.60	23.3	18.2	15.3
ADYEN.NA (Adyen)	O	EUR	803.10	1,600.00	(65.9)%	EUR	33.62	42.83	51.05	23.9	18.8	15.7
XYZ (Block Inc)	O	USD	66.63	85.00	(19.7)%	USD	2,084	3,347	4,700	19.0	11.8	8.4
FIS (FIS)	M	USD	38.97	73.00	(74.9)%	USD	5.76	6.30	6.91	6.8	6.2	5.6
FISV(Fiserv)	M	USD	53.28	76.00	(91.4)%	USD	8.64	8.06	8.76	6.2	6.6	6.1
GPN (Global Payments)	M	USD	62.47	86.00	(45.6)%	USD	12.22	13.89	16.13	5.1	4.5	3.9
KLAR (Klarna)	M	USD	15.78	20.00	NA	USD	65.1	305.3	461.7	40.1	8.5	5.7
MA (Mastercard)	O	USD	489.08	710.00	(40.0)%	USD	17.01	19.82	22.82	28.8	24.7	21.4
PYPL (PayPal)	M	USD	40.70	45.00	(68.5)%	USD	5.31	5.23	5.30	7.7	7.8	7.7
TOST (Toast)	O	USD	24.30	39.00	(66.9)%	USD	633.00	802.78	990.80	19.5	15.4	12.5
V (Visa)	O	USD	322.96	450.00	(35.9)%	USD	11.47	13.17	15.16	28.2	24.5	21.3
SPX			7,386.65									
EDME			1,533.88									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

XYZ estimate is EBIT (M); KLAR estimate is Adjusted EBIT; TOST estimate is EBITDA (M); XYZ valuation is EV/EBIT (x); KLAR valuation is EV/Adj EBIT (x);

TOST valuation is EV/EBITDA (x);

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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